

Ali Yaacoub

Aspiring Solicitor

Agile, detail-oriented professional with 3+ years of experience in providing legal advice and support to clients within international and multicultural firms. Experienced paralegal in Intellectual Property, Corporate and Commercial law, highly confident with leadership qualities and strong communication and interpersonal skills which helped me achieve great goals and results such as establishing excellent relationships with the Emirates authorities. Having studied for and sat the Solicitors Qualifying Examination (SQE) Stage 1 and 2, I expect to qualify as a Solicitor in England and Wales around September 2022.

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PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Layoff/position eliminated

Career Break
July 2020 – Present

My employment was terminated due to the pandemic. During this period, I have studied Law and have prepared to sit for the SQE.

Paralegal

Bird & Bird (MEA) LLP
September 2018 – June 2020 **Dubai, UAE**

- Handling day-to-day prosecution and enforcement of domestic and foreign trade marks
- Preparing and filing registration, opposition, renewal, cancellation, recordal and complaint applications
- Conducting market surveys, use investigations and trade mark and company searches
- Conducting trainings to the local authorities such as Customs and Economic Departments
- Undertaking raids and attending destructions of counterfeit products with the local authorities
- Due diligence related to trade mark and IPR portfolios including auditing of data from national IPO and other commercial databases
- Drafting, filing and managing various business entity documents for corporations, LLCs and partnerships
- Drafting and reviewing contracts and commercial agreements
- Conducting AML/KYC background checks for new clients onboarding purposes
- Coordinating with outside counsels and advising clients on IP, Corporate and Commercial matters
- Running a docketing diary, issuing reminders to lawyers and ensuring that the diary for relevant cases is always current
- Preparing fee quotes and processing invoices
- Drafting and translating legal documents such as PoAs, C&Ds, Undertaking and Complaint Letters, Technical Reports, Affidavits, etc.

Trade Mark Watch Coordinator

SABA Intellectual Property
April 2017 – August 2018 **Beirut, Lebanon**

- Monitoring official gazettes and detecting trade mark infringements
- Preparing watch notices and sending them to clients
- Updating the database through access of input and analysis of data
- Researching via internet, official gazettes, cases etc.
- Checking and reviewing emails constantly with a leading action to correspond with clients
- Thoroughly analysing potential conflicts, performing clearance check and working on conflict resolution by examining current database, reverting back on previous cases and reviewing clients' instructions
- Preparing and following up on invoices

EDUCATIONAL BACKGROUND

SQE Stage 2 Prep Course

BARBRI
January 2022 – March 2022

INTERNSHIPS

Assistant Event Organizer

Infomed International for Events
January 2017 – February 2017

Research Assistant

Global Coalition for Efficient Logistics
November 2016 – January 2017

Database Analyst

International Fairs & Promotions
January 2016 – March 2016

Teller & Personal Banker

Byblos Bank
July 2013 – August 2013

ACHIEVEMENTS, CERTIFICATES, AWARDS

Speaker – Learnings from the First SQE Cohort

BARBRI
March 2022
Forum not recorded

Speaker – Are You Considering a Career as a Solicitor?

BARBRI
February 2022
https://youtu.be/ILsJmvOH_yw

Speaker – Studying for the SQE as an International Student

BARBRI
April 2021
<https://youtu.be/O75BZzCrlNo>

Pearson Test of English (PTE) Academic

Pearson
October 2020

Team Captain – Zurich Corporate Touch Rugby

Bird & Bird (MEA) LLP
March 2019

Team Captain – Bloomberg Square Mile Relay

Bird & Bird (MEA) LLP
February 2019

Certificate of Appreciation

Abu Dhabi General Administration of Customs
November 2018

English Proficiency Assessment

Saint Louis University
August 2014

SQE Stage 1 Prep Course

BARBRI

January 2021 – October 2021

Masters in Management

Saint Joseph University

September 2014 – September 2016

Bachelor in Business

Saint Joseph University

September 2011 – June 2014

LANGUAGES

Arabic	Native
English	Fluent
French	Fluent

PUBLICATION

Counterfeit Mobile Devices - More Than Just a Security Risk

Bird & Bird LLP

July 2019

<https://www.twobirds.com/en/insights/2019/uae/counterfeit-mobile-devices-more-than-just-a-security-risk>

HOBBIES & INTERESTS

Weight Lifting

Swimming

Biking

Travelling